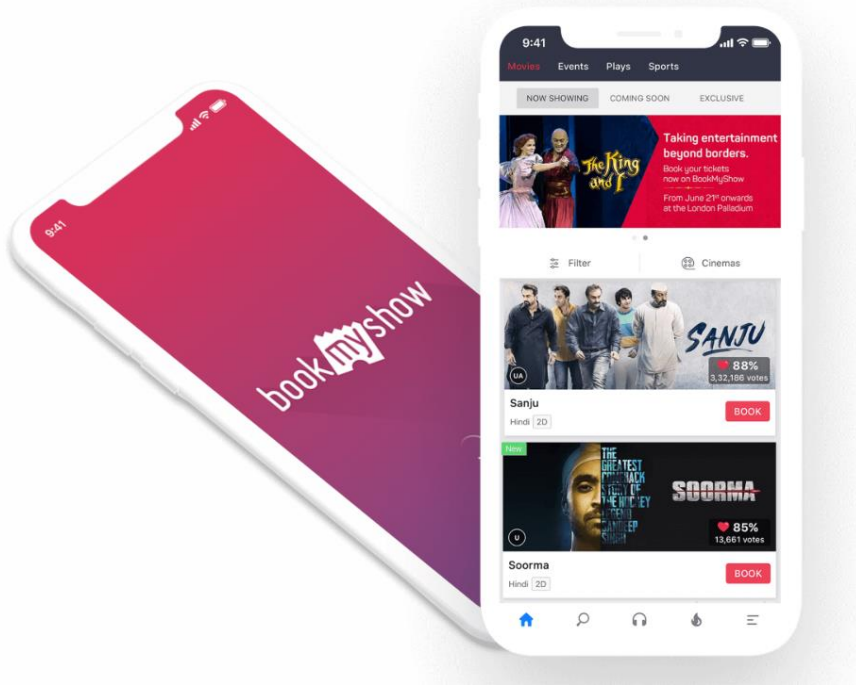
Product Teardown

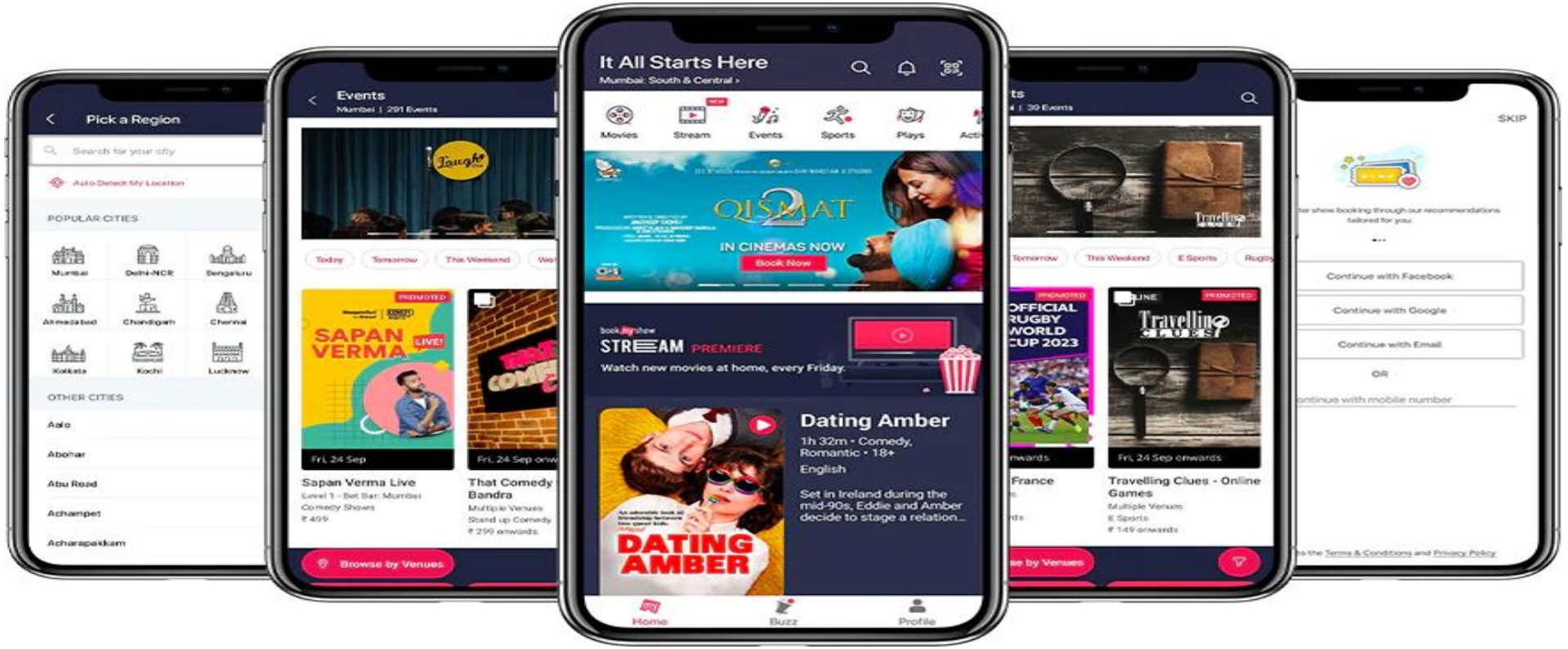
Movie reviews feature on the BookMyShow app

By Nitin Sahu



Overview

- BookMyShow is a popular entertainment ticketing platform that allows users to book tickets for various entertainment events, including movies, plays, concerts, sports events, and more.
- It is available both as a website and mobile app.
- In addition to ticket booking, BookMyShow also offers users the ability to read and write reviews of movies and events and access to trailers and other promotional material.
- In this product teardown, we will focus on the feature of reading and writing reviews of movies on the BookMyShow app.



Key Statistics

- 78% market share in the online movie ticketing sector.
- 5 countries, 650+ towns and cities, 5000+ screens.
- 50M+ app downloads on Google Play store.
- 4.3 rating (1M+ reviews) on Google Play store.
- 70M monthly active users (MAU).
- 250M customer visits per month.
- 66% revenue comes movie ticket sales.
- 75% of transactions being driven through mobile.

User Demography

(India : Oct'22 – Sep'23)

Gender Distribution:

Male – 82.9%
Female – 17.1%

Age Distribution:

25-34 years – 48%
18-24 years – 28%
34-44 years – 20%
45-54 years – 4%



App demographics of BookMyShow, Source: Similarweb

User Personas



Name: Hina Agarwal

Age: 28 years

Profession: Project Manager at a Tech company, who loves to watch films over the weekends.

Needs:

- An online platform to buy movie tickets.
- Read genuine movie ratings/reviews to decide which films to watch and also share her thoughts once she watches a film.



Name: Prateek Kumar

Age: 20 years

Profession: Tech savvy college kid who loves watching movies with friends, albeit selectively due to budget crunch.

Needs:

- An online platform to buy movie tickets.
- Read genuine movie reviews to select which film to watch.



Name: Sohini Roy

Age: 39 years

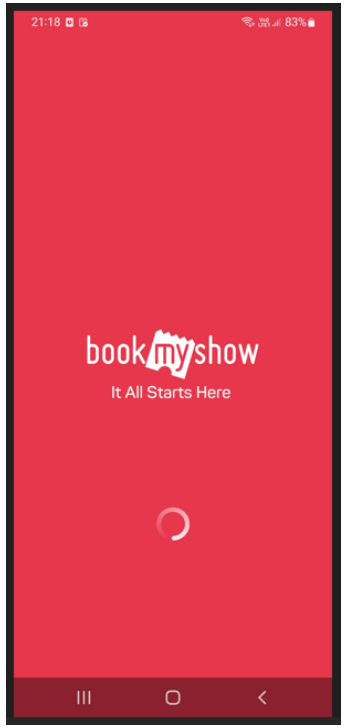
Profession: Professor who loves watching films and writing detailed reviews of the films she watches.

Needs:

- An online platform to buy movie tickets.
- Read and write legit movie reviews to help people take well-informed decisions about which film to watch.

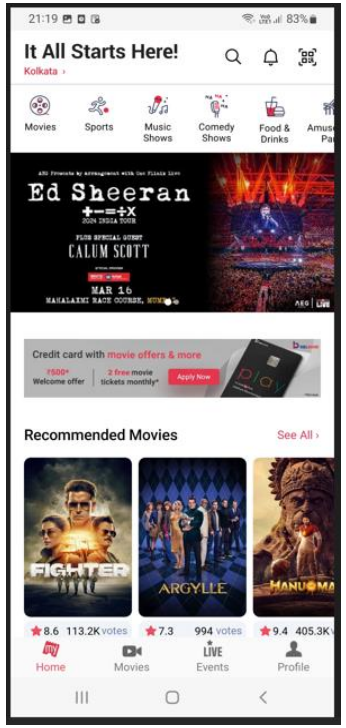
User Flow

1



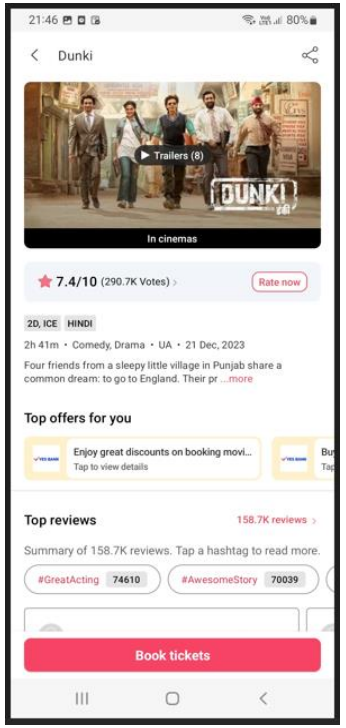
App opening page

2



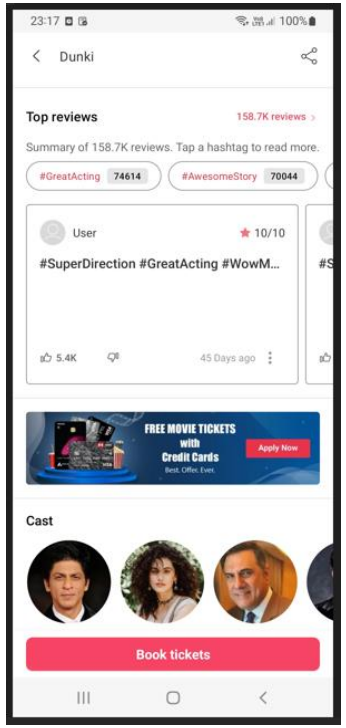
App home page showing various movies, events etc.

3



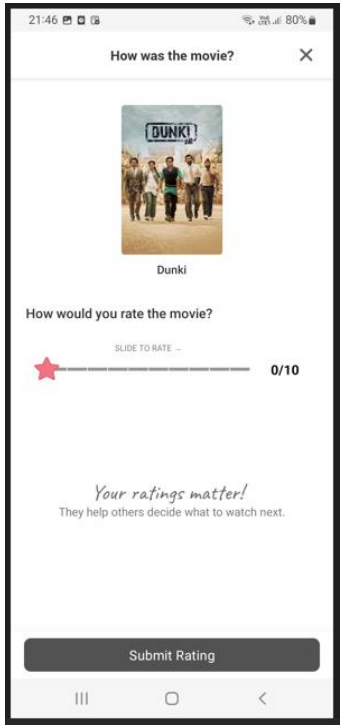
Once you click on the movie you want to rate and review on the home page, the app takes you to the movie details page.

4



If you scroll down the movie details page in Step 3, it brings you to the “Top reviews” section containing positive reviews of the film.

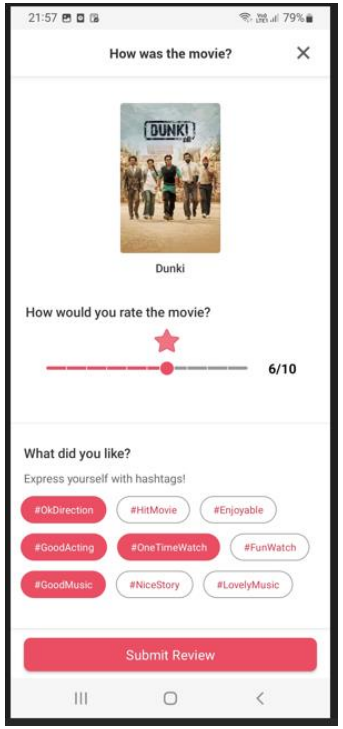
5



If you click on “Rate now” in Step 3, it brings you to the Ratings page where you can rate the movie.

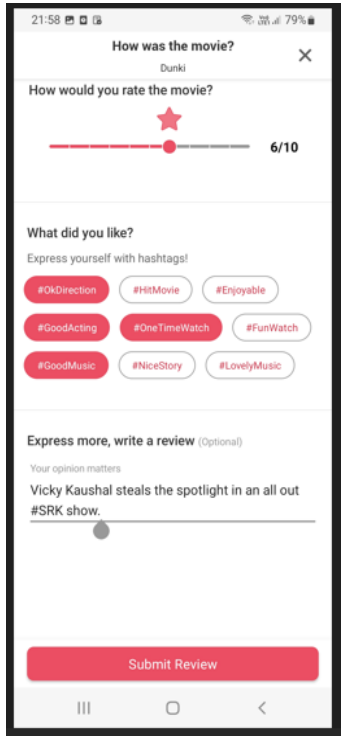
User Flow

6



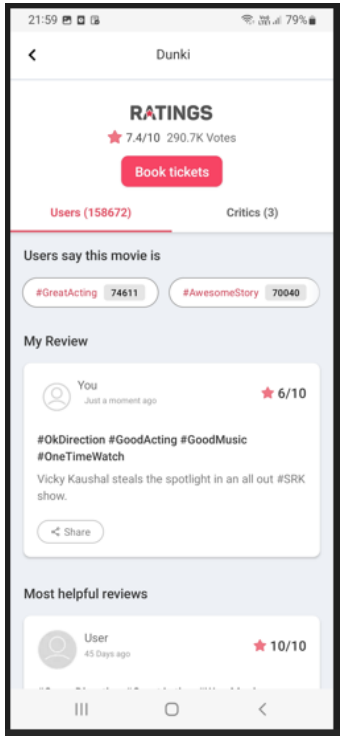
You can rate the film by dragging the star shaped slider to your desired rating (out of 10). You can also select your desired hashtags.

7



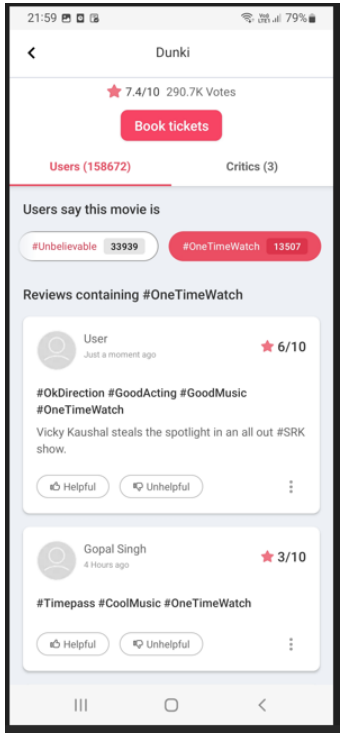
You can also write your review of the film. This is optional. Once done, click on “Submit Review”.

8



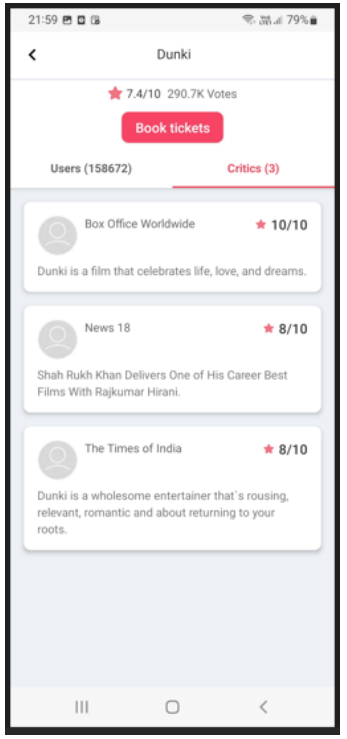
Once you submit your review, you are taken to the “Ratings” which has all the reviews from users (including yours) and critics.

9



You can filter user reviews based on a hashtag. Numbers indicate how many users have used a specific hashtag.

10



You can also select the “Critics” tab to read critics’ ratings and a one-line review of the movie.

Pain Points and Improvement Suggestions

PAIN POINT 1: No legitimacy of reviews posted by users.

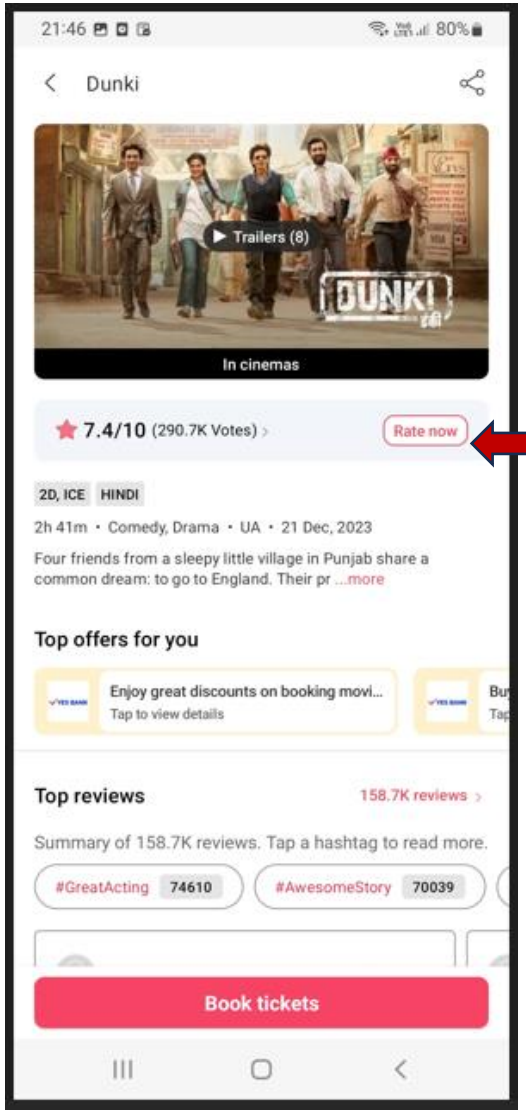
Today, any registered BookMyShow user can click on “Rate now” option on any movie details page and rate/review it, irrespective of whether he/she has actually watched the movie or not. Hence, one cannot ascertain if the review is genuine or not. A “Booked on bookmyshow” sticker is visible under a user who has used BMS to watch the film. This does help to identify genuine reviewers, but majority of reviewers do not have any such distinguishing mark. This factor can be abused by miscreants who want to spread bulk misinformation (both positive or negative) about a film.

IMPROVEMENT SUGGESTIONS:

BookMyShow should mandatorily have atleast two criteria for allowing a user to post his/her review of a movie:

1. The person should be a registered user on BookMyShow.
2. The user should have used BookMyShow to book tickets of the movie.

This will increase the probability of genuineness of reviews by manifold.

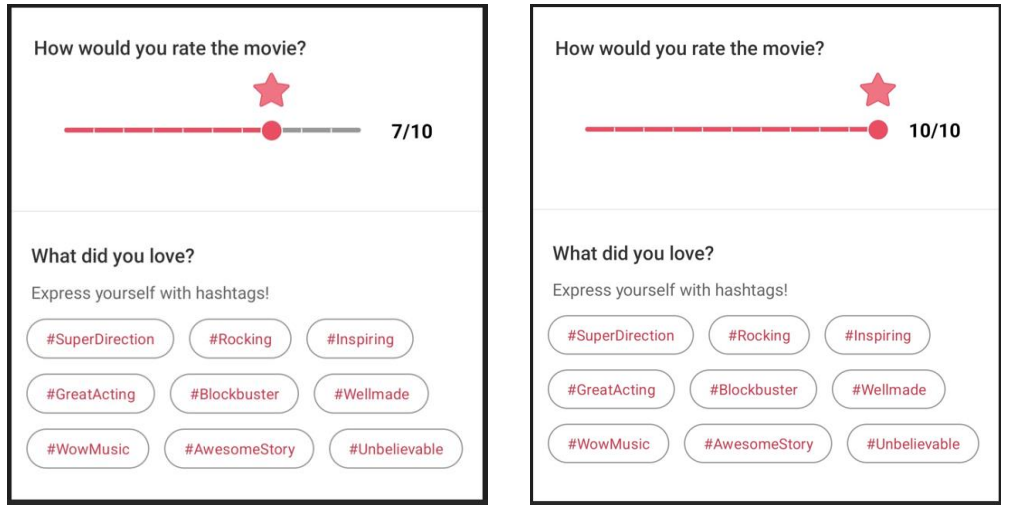


Any registered BMS user can rate/review any movie by clicking here, irrespective of whether he/she has watched the movie or not.

Pain Points and Improvement Suggestions

PAIN POINT 2: Same hashtags for a wide range of ratings. No option to create custom hashtags.

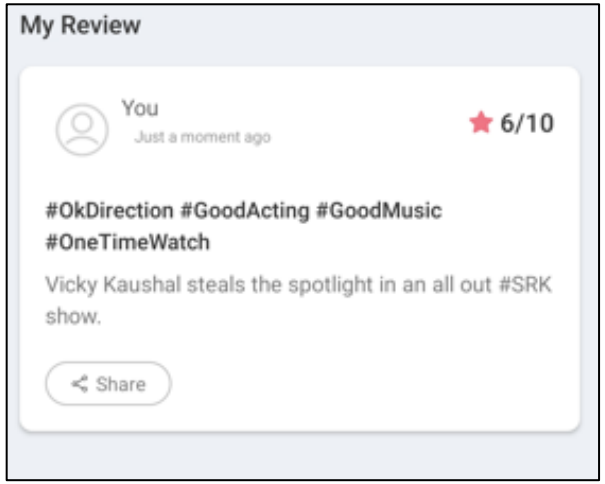
1. In BookMyShow, all hashtags are autogenerated and there are three sets of hashtags: One set for Ratings 1-3, another set for ratings 4-6 and a third set for ratings 7-10. So, a movie with rating 10 can have a hashtag of "Unbelievable" and so too can a movie with rating 7. Needless to say, a '7/10' movie cannot be same as a '10/10' movie. This leads to similar reviews but starkly different ratings appearing under same hashtag filter which is again misleading.
2. Also, user cannot create their custom hashtags. They can put hashtags in their reviews, but these hashtags do not appear in bold like the autogenerated ones do. Users have different emotions attached to specific films. Like a Shah Rukh Khan fan might want to create an SRK related hashtag to express his/her sentiments. Sadly, this option is not available on BMS.



Same hashtags generated for rating '7/10' as well as for '10/10'
No option to create custom hashtags above.

IMPROVEMENT SUGGESTION:

1. Instead of having the same set of hashtags over a group of 3 or 4 different ratings (e.g. one set for ratings 7 -10), BMS can have 5 sets of hashtags (with marked qualitative difference) for 5 groups of 2 ratings each (i.e. one set for ratings 7-8, different set for ratings 9-10 etc.). This will lead to better differentiation between truly quality films and mediocre stuff.
2. BookMyShow should allow users to create custom hashtags alongside using the autogenerated ones. For streamlined filtering, it can continue to keep its hashtag filters available only for its autogenerated hashtags, but the users should be allowed to express themselves more freely. This will improve customer engagement with the review feature.



If one uses a hashtag in his/her review (e.g. here #SRK), it does not appear in bold as the ones which are autogenerated.

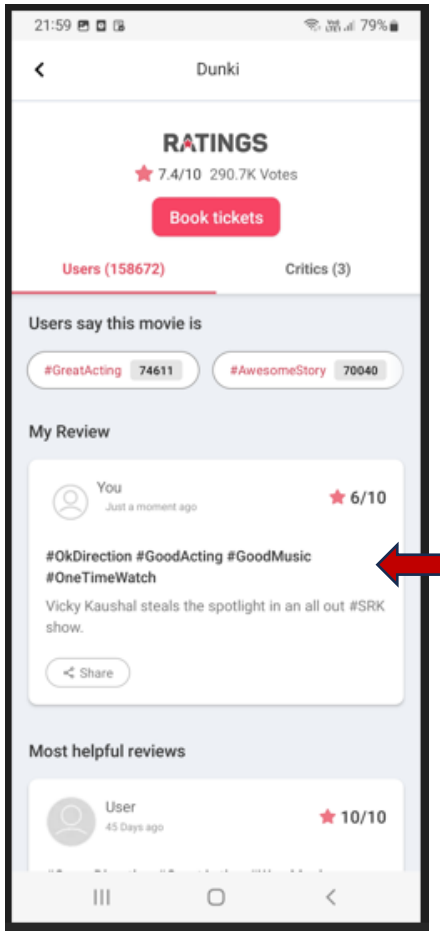
Pain Points and Improvement Suggestions

PAIN POINT 3: Rating/Review once submitted cannot be edited.

There is no option to edit one's rating or review after he/she has submitted it.
While the user may not want to change the overall rating of the film (although this needs to be verified through user research) but chances are high that the user might want to modify something like correct a typo in his/her review. But currently there is no such option to modify one's rating/review in BookMyShow.

IMPROVEMENT SUGGESTION:

BMS should allow users to modify one's rating/review of a film, even if for a certain duration of time (like WhatsApp allowing to edit sent message up to 15mins from the time of sending). This will increase customer engagement with the app.



No option to edit rating/review once submitted.

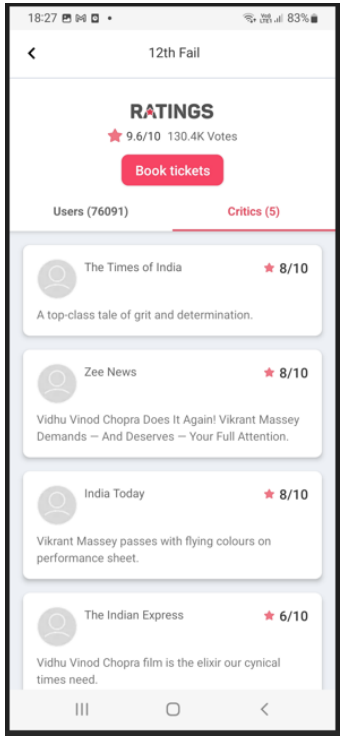
Pain Points and Improvement Suggestions

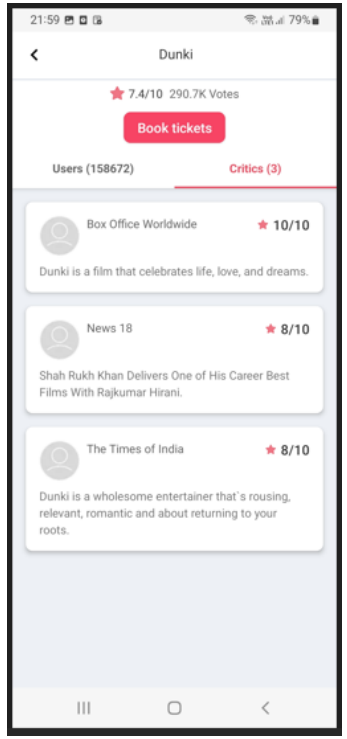
PAIN POINT 4: No standard list of “Critics” reviews.

1. Any blockbuster film (at least in India) is usually critiqued by most standard dailies. But if one goes, to the “Critics” reviews tab in BookMyShow, for different films, there are different set of critics and that too sometimes not authentic ones. There is not set standard (like same set of critics) which would help the user compare two films based on critics’ reviews.
2. Also, there is no scope for reading the entire review of the critic. There is only a single line blurb available. If a user chooses to read the entire review of a particular critic, he/she needs to search for it separately over the internet.

IMPROVEMENT SUGGESTIONS:

1. BMS should use a standard set of critics in its “Critics” reviews section for every film.
2. BMS should have a way to redirect a user to the original review piece of the critic, should the user choose to read the review in its entirety.





- *No standard set of critics. “12th Fail” on the left has 5 critics’ reviews while “Dunki” on the right has 3 critics’ reviews with just one common critic (The Times of India).*
- *No way to read the entire review, especially when rating and review do not match up. (e.g. 12th Fail on the left has been rated 6/10 by The Indian Express but has a glowing review blurb.*

THANK YOU